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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

SPECTACULAR OPENING TO GLOBAL VILLAGE

Global Village kicked off the way residents know best — with music, fanfare and bursts of silver confetti. The theme was 'A More Wonderful World', which was written across banners that carried the pictures of postage stamps of landmark cities. The opening celebrations began at 6pm yesterday with a choir performance, followed by the Parade of the World, featuring performers representing cultures from across the globe. Now in its 31st season, the Dubai destination brings together shopping, dining, live shows and family attractions, making it a popular outing for UAE residents during the cooler months. SEE ALSO P4

UAE launches $1m Global Innovation Challenge

AI challenge, an opportunities centre and young leaders programme launched

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

The Global Innovation Challenge and Agentic AI Award will offer a $1 million prize, with 10,000 Global Shapers across 150 countries expected to develop solutions to modern-day challenges.

The UAE has launched three initiatives with the World Economic Forum (WEF), including a $1 million Global Innovation Challenge focused on agentic artificial intelligence, a centre to turn emerging technologies and economic opportunities into policy, and a programme to spotlight 20 future leaders under the age of 30.

Mohammad Al Gergawi, UAE Minister of Cabinet Affairs, announced the initiatives at the opening plenary of the World Economic Forum Annual Meeting of Global Future Leaders, bringing together leaders and entrepreneurs from more than 100 countries.

UAE-WEF partnership

The Global Centre for Future Opportunities will be established through a UAE-WEF partnership to translate technological advances and economic opportunities into policies, he said.

The Global Innovation Challenge and Agentic AI Award will offer a $1 million prize, with 10,000 Global Shapers across 150 countries expected to develop solutions to modern-day challenges. The winners will be announced at the next meeting in 2027, said the Minister.

The third initiative, Future 20, will spotlight 20 people under the age of 30 who have the potential to influence the future, lead communities and turn ideas into opportunities for millions of people.

SEE ALSO P-II

World's oldest shipwreck found off Turkey's coast

Cargo, anchors date to the age of pyramids

DUBAI

BY ALEX ABRAHAM
Senior Associate Editor

Archaeologists have discovered what they believe is the world's oldest known shipwreck off the coast of Turkey, dating back as far as 4,700 years to the Early Bronze Age, around the time the Great Pyramid of Giza was being built in Egypt.



The remains of the ancient trading vessel were found near Kekova Island in Turkey's southern Antalya province, about 30 metres beneath the Mediterranean Sea.

Although the ship's wooden structure has disappeared over the millennia, researchers discovered more than 30 ceramic storage vessels and three large stone anchors scattered across the seabed. Some of the pots still contain traces of their original contents, according to the BBC.

Researchers believe the vessel was approximately 10 metres long and transported goods across the Mediterranean between ancient trading centres.

The discovery is particularly significant because the shipwreck is estimated to be between 4,400 and 4,700 years old, potentially making it several centuries older than the previously recognised record holder near the Greek island of Dokos.

Saudi Arabia intercepts Houthi missiles as tensions escalate

IRAN-BACKED GROUP TARGETS ARAMCO SITE AS WELL AS RIYADH AIRPORT

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

The Saudi Civil Defence yesterday reported that falling shrapnel from an intercepted ballistic missile in Riyadh injured a resident of Arab nationality and caused minor damage to a residential building and a vehicle as Iran-backed Houthis stepped up their campaign.

The Houthis said they had targeted facilities belonging to Saudi oil giant Aramco as well as Riyadh airport, as they vowed to conduct more attacks.

Earlier, Saudi Arabia's civil defence agency said that four people — two women, a man and a child — were wounded by debris from two intercepted Houthi cruise missiles in the capital and that 15 homes were damaged. The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations (UKMTO) agency also reported that two commercial vessels were hit by "unknown projectiles" in separate incidents in the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said yesterday that a ship caught fire and sank in the Strait of Hormuz because of a mine, while British security firm Vanguard also reported a sinking.

Saudi strikes on Yemen

The Saudi-led coalition, meanwhile, struck oil sites across western Yemen on Tuesday, with spokesman Turki Al Malki saying the attacks targeted facilities used to "threaten the kingdom, Yemen, the southern Red Sea and waterways". The Saudi cabinet vowed in a meeting led by Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman that it "will not allow its security or freedom of navigation in the Red Sea and Bab Al Mandab Strait to be threatened".

Sports events postponed

The Saudi Arabian football league (SPL) said it has postponed three fixtures, including one involving Cristiano Ronaldo's Al Nassr.

Organisers also announced that the Six Kings Slam tennis tournament, originally slated to start next week, would be pushed back to December.

US President Donald Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform on Tuesday that "the Houthis are behaving very badly", accusing them of acting "probably at the behest of Iran".

SEE ALSO P7, P-IV

'NEGATIVE SPILLOVER' OF SAUDI ATTACKS

The head of the International Monetary Fund said yesterday that recent attacks on Saudi Arabia could impact people "everywhere", as energy costs rise globally and multiple conflicts rage in the crude-rich region.

"The Saudi economy is important for the region and the world, and in that sense, these developments have potentially negative spillovers for everybody, everywhere," Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva said at a news conference during the Annual Meetings of the IMF and the World Bank in Bangkok. —AFP



ABU DHABI

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IN FOCUS

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